

vibrant and haze-free). When you open the dialog, you're presented with a Histogram, which shows how the colours in the image are distributed between fully black and fully white. This will make more sense if you choose one of the channels from the drop-down menu. The histogram for the Blue channel, for example (shown here), shows that the most widely distributed shade of blue is around the 50 per cent mark.

A good histogram covers all intensities—it means that the image has pixels that cover the full range of colour for each channel. A flat area on the left means that there aren't enough dark pixels, leaving the image looking washed out (which is what we have in this case). Conversely, a flat area on the right will look too dark and dull. The solution to our problem is to drag the black slider from the extreme left to the beginning of the histogram—for each channel. This simple activity results in a massive improvement in the image.



Beginning with the dull image